



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Communication Skills

PRINCIPLES OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- “The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation.”
- “You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge).”
- “You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event.”
- “Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event.”

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.
2. Explain the nature of effective written communications.
3. Explain the nature of staff communication.
4. Defend ideas objectively.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the founder and owner of CAMPUS CREATIONS, a new business that specializes in custom school supplies, such as personalized notebooks, backpacks, and pens. The business is still in its early stages and has gained a small but loyal customer base. You want to expand your reach and attract more high school students and their families.

The business has recently launched a new product line of eco-friendly school supplies made from sustainable materials. You need to communicate this new offering to potential customers in a way that aligns with your brand's mission of promoting both creativity and environmental responsibility.

Your task is to:

- Develop a clear and compelling message about your new eco-friendly products that appeals to both environmentally conscious students and their parents.
- Determine the best communication channels to use (social media, email, word of mouth, etc.) to reach your target audience effectively.
- Explain how you will handle questions from potential customers about the eco-friendly materials, pricing, and product benefits.
- Address any concerns customers might have about the cost or value of eco-friendly products versus traditional alternatives.
- Present a plan for how to maintain customer engagement and loyalty after the product launch.

You will present your plan to a potential investor (judge) who is interested in learning more about how you plan to grow your business and communicate your new product offerings. The investor (judge) will begin the role-play by asking you to share your communication strategy. After you have explained your plan and answered their questions, the investor (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How will you measure the success of your communication strategy and determine whether it's effectively reaching and engaging your target audience?
2. How do you plan to manage customer feedback and handle any negative perceptions about eco-friendly products being more expensive than traditional options?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Explain the nature of effective written communications.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Explain the nature of staff communication.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Defend ideas objectively.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
5.	Unique Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	Practical Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Effective Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
8.	Critical Thinking Think critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	Communication Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Decision Making Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
11.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
TOTAL SCORE						